The Birds and the Bees

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/59785195.

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Teen And Up Audiences

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Bow (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra), Melog (She-Ra)

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by Lyssandia

Summary

Bow instantly blushed before he could answer that through his own embarrassment, though she moved on, probably because Melog encouraged her to. “Adora believes we could be pregnant from kissing… the Horde taught us that. But… I've seen people kissing there and I've never seen anyone pregnant right after so… tell me, Arrow-boy, is Adora right?”

Notes

This short fic was written for a prompt on our dear Rinnii's discord server!
The prompt was: "Event: "Kissing makes you pregnant, don’t you know?"
Prompt: Sex ed is bad in the horde, so Adora thinks that "kissing is how you get pregnant". After the heart she believes that she (and maybe Catra) is now pregnant. How does she tell others and how do they react?"

So this is what I came up with!

Beware that this story deals with sex education and is about menstruation and menstruation pain!

Have fun!

Many thanks to CanadianBear, Paganaidd and Lisra for beta-reading!

See the end of the work for more notes

Bow never thought he'd be at a loss for words like that ever. That someone would ask him a question that would make him utterly speechless. Or that he would have to hold back his laugh so hard, because the person asking him was seriously concerned.

But here he was, trying very hard to focus on the task at hand and maintain his serious face.

It was already very clear that Catra was embarrassed asking him this, fidgeting with her claws and sending him glances that clearly told him she'd kill him if he dared to laugh or talk about this with anyone else.

That Melog stayed close to her and nudged her from time to time also had to mean something.

But he also felt a tiny bit honored that she came to him.

"There's no one else I could ask about this," she had said and her face had been redder than he's ever seen it.

"There's no way this is true! I see you and Sparkles kiss all the time, and so far, Glitter-bomb is not pregnant, right?"

Bow instantly blushed before he could answer that through his own embarrassment, though she moved on, probably because Melog encouraged her to. "Adora believes we could be pregnant from kissing… the Horde taught us that. But… I've seen people kissing there and I've never seen anyone pregnant right after so… tell me, Arrow-boy, is Adora right?"

Bow had never expected her to ask him such a question and he needed a moment to collect some words to answer appropriately without laughing, taking her fully seriously, because one thing was clear: She wasn't joking.

Apparently, he was taking a bit too long to answer for her, seeing that Melog's mane was turning a dark red and how she was biting on her bottom lip.

“No, Catra!” He hastily answered. “No, you need to do a bit more than just kissing to become pregnant.”

It wasn’t hard to see the weight falling off her heart. She sighed with relief and stood there, still looking a bit lost, even though Melog tried to ground her with their presence.

“Should I talk to Adora about it?” He offered. Bow imagined that it must still be hard for the feline to talk about things like that.

Her face turned red again and she clenched her fists. She looked like she was ready to bolt, but she stayed, maybe thanks to Melog. It took her a moment to finally nod. “That… would be great.”

Bow gave her a smile. She was doing so well with her anger management. Seeing her being able to recognize when her emotions were boiling over and manage to calm down by herself, despite the fact she probably felt incredibly vulnerable, showed him how much she *wanted* to change. Having her alien companion with her helped with that as well.

Everything must be so new to her in Bright Moon, but so far, she hadn’t lashed out at anyone. Bow wasn’t sure if that was to Melog's credit that there hadn't been an incident, or if she just bolted whenever something became too much to bear, but she had clearly been trying to bond with everyone and actively tried to be friendly.

The archer didn't harbor any hard feelings towards her anymore, not after seeing how happy she made Adora. And it had helped that Catra actually made the effort to apologize to him a few days ago for throwing him off a cliff once, too.

“Okay,” he finally answered, assuming that the conversation would be over now.

But to his surprise, she looked at him once more, her face deep red again.

“Ehm… if you don’t mind… could you…” she cursed under her breath, “well… eh… explain? To me?”

“Explain what?” He asked, dumbfounded.

“Ugh! How people get pregnant, you doofus!” She yelled with a growl, tail lashing and ears pinned back, Melog's mane turning red for a second. Her eyes widened, realizing what she had done, and she hugged herself, giving him an apologetic glance before lowering her eyes. “Sorry.”

Bow knew she didn't mean to lash out. Maybe she was just too embarrassed and this situation made her too vulnerable. He understood that change was hard for someone who was never allowed to show any weakness or vulnerability.

“Sure, I can do that. But maybe not here in the hallway? Let’s go somewhere more private.”

She nodded in agreement and shortly after, they were sitting down in the grass of Bright Moon’s gardens, enjoying the daylight and soft breeze, bringing the smell of blooming flowers with it.

“So…,” he began, breaking the awkward, deafening silence. “What do you already know about sex?”

“Sex? What’s that?” She asked back, her expression confused, her fingers fidgeting with Melog's mane.

“Well… ehm… to get pregnant, you have to have sex. That means, you are intimate with someone…” When Catra’s face got even more befuddled, he came to the realization that the Horde definitely never properly educated its people about this at all. He briefly remembered that Adora didn’t even know what a horse was when they first met. They didn’t know animals at all, maybe except for some mice or rats. In other words, they never saw any natural life cycles anywhere.

“Ehm, well, you do have a vulva, right? Down there?” He pointed between her legs and she nodded.

“Great. So, as a female, you have a womb up there. The uterus.”

“Yeah, that’s the nasty thing that makes us bleed every other week.”

“Exactly. Do you know what that bleeding is there for?”

Catra took a moment to think. “Wait! That’s somehow connected to getting pregnant?” She figured.

Delighted at her sharp mind, he nodded again. “Yes. The bleeding comes when you’re not pregnant. It will stop when you have a baby in your womb.”

“Oooooh!” Catra finally seemed to be making some connections she probably never even thought about before. “So I can’t be pregnant because I’ve got… nevermind.”

Her flushed and embarrassed face told him she probably was on her period right now.

“It's okay. Are you in pain?”

Bow knew Glimmer couldn’t deal with her first days without her hot water bottle and sometimes even needed painkillers.

At first, Catra didn't react; she only petted Melog, but after a while, she eventually nodded.

“What do you usually do when you’re in period pain?” He asked.

“What do you mean?” she asked back. “It's normal. We just endure. That’s what everyone does, right?”

Bow’s shocked face made her rethink. “It's not…?”

“No! A bit of discomfort maybe, but if you're in serious pain, you can get some meds to help or get a hot water bottle on your belly!”

“Oh.” Catra suddenly looked bewildered, and Bow could see tears form in the corners of her eyes.

He wondered how much pain she was in. Having to endure this every month and getting told it was normal seemed cruel to him.

“We'll get you some help with that. You certainly don’t have to endure it. Do you want me to explain how to get pregnant before that?”

“Yeah…” She replied, wiping her eyes with the back of her hand.

“Okay, so… you know we guys have penises, right?” He waited until she nodded before going on. “Great. So, in order to get pregnant, a penis must go inside your vagina and release semen. That’s a whitish fluid that contains lots and lots of cells. And those cells will reach an egg cell in your womb. If those meet, you'll get pregnant. Your period means that your egg cell died and got washed out.”

Catra looked at him with wide eyes. “What do you mean, a penis would need to enter my vagina?”

“Well, that’s what’s called sex. In order to get pregnant, you'd need to have sex with a guy or at least find a way to release semen in you. Kissing alone won’t do it.” He explained with a wink.

“So… since Adora and I are both girls, we…”

“Yes. Neither of you will get pregnant just with that. Also, you can have sex in different ways, like, using your fingers and mouth and some toys, but you still won’t get pregnant from those.”

Catra looked even more relieved than before, even with that cute blush still covering her freckled face. “Okay. That explains a lot. Ehm… thanks. For taking your time and all.”

“You're welcome. And now, let’s see if we can find some help with your pain.”

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The warmth spread around her belly, reaching where it was needed after just a few minutes, and Catra sighed with the relief it brought. She almost couldn’t believe that Bow was right - but he definitely was. The cramps she always had in the first days didn't stop completely, but they weren’t as bad anymore.

Why the Horde never told them that just a bit of warmth could help with period pain was beyond her. If she hadn’t felt so relaxed right now, lying on the sofa in the so-called den with her head leaning on Melog, she probably would have been upset about it.

Maybe it also helped that she was nibbling on some sweet brown bar-like thing Bow had called “chocolate” and claimed that Sparkles could never survive without it. Catra decided she liked chocolate after having a bite that exploded with the most amazing new flavor on her tongue.

Chewing, she just enjoyed the relaxation now, waiting for the painkillers to do their magic and chuckled when she heard Bow explaining *things* to Adora, watching them with amusement, especially at Adora’s dumb face.

“Sooo… we don’t get pregnant from kissing?” Adora asked, and Bow nodded.

“Nope! Not even when you kiss a guy.” Bow replied.

Catra was grateful that he was such a good person. He hadn’t judged her and had taken her seriously, just as she had expected when she considered asking him about this.

Not that she would ever say that.

But she was also glad he volunteered to talk to Adora.

“And in order to have a baby, we'd need… a guy…?” Adora asked and Bow nodded.

“Yes, or at least some semen. There are ways if you want a child.”

“Huh,” Adora said, and Catra grinned at her.

“Told you so, princess!” she teased, licking the last chocolate remains from her fingers.

Adora blew her a raspberry. “As if you had known any better!”

“At least I asked and didn't run around in panic!” Catra shot back, delighted when she saw Adora pouting.

Bow chuckled. “Obviously the Horde wasn’t great with sex education, but I'm glad you asked. Are you feeling better now, Catra?”

The feline blushed a bit. She wasn’t used to this - that anybody would care if she was ok other than Adora or Scorpia.

But she nodded. “Yeah. I can’t believe it, but this,” she pointed to the hot water bottle on her belly, “actually helps.”

It took some encouragement from Melog to add “Thank you.”

“You're welcome! I hope it'll be gone soon.” With that, he got up and headed to the door. “I'll leave you two for now. See you at dinner!”

Adora crossed the room when Bow was gone, sitting down next to Catra, gently taking her hand into hers. “I… never knew you were in such pain during this time of month...”

“I thought it was just normal. Isn’t it the same for you?” Catra asked.

Adora shook her head. “No. It was a bit more uncomfortable when I was younger, but it usually was ok. Not that I like having them, but I'm not in that much pain.”

She looked at the hot-water-bottle, glad it was helping her girlfriend. “I'm sorry it’s painful for you.”

“Eh, at least I'm definitely not pregnant!” Catra managed to grin, which turned into a smile when Adora smiled at her.

“That means I can kiss you as much as I want!” Adora’s smile became smug, then she leaned down, looking at Catra’s mismatched eyes, waiting for a reaction.

Catra suddenly felt something else in her belly, a pleasant tickle that made her heart beat faster with excitement.

“Yeah..,” she whispered, “we can kiss all day…”

With that, she closed the gap between their lips and felt safer than ever in her life, finally following her heart.

End Notes

I hope you had fun reading this little story!
I'm always delighted to receive feedback of any kind!

Also: To have discomfort during your period is normal. A bit of pain is normal. But if you're experiencing a lot of pain that is hard to deal with every month, please don't be too shy to ask your gynecologist about it! As someone who has a form of endometriosis myself and lived with years of pain thinking it was normal, that's an advice I'd like to give you! A lot of pain is NOT normal and you probably should get that checked out.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!